

STATE OF NEW YORK

2439--B

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN ASSEMBLY

January 16, 2025

Introduced by M. of A. EPSTEIN, SEAWRIGHT, GONZALEZ-ROJAS, REYES, BURDICK, PAULIN, SIMON, WOERNER, LEVENBERG, KELLES, CUNNINGHAM, DE LOS SANTOS, OTIS, GLICK, McMAHON, TAPIA, RAGA, SIMONE, SHRESTHA, JACOBSON, ROSENTHAL, SHIMSKY, LEE, WEPRIN, LAVINE, MAMDANI, HEVESI, FORREST, LASHER, CRUZ, GALLAGHER -- read once and referred to the Committee on Health -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee -- again reported from said committee with amendments, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the public health law, in relation to enacting the New York state abortion clinical training program act

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

Section 1. The public health law is amended by adding a new article 25-AA to read as follows:

ARTICLE 25-AA

NEW YORK STATE ABORTION CLINICAL TRAINING PROGRAM ACT

Section 2599-bb-10. Policy and purpose.

2599-bb-11. Definitions.

2599-bb-12. Establishment of the New York state abortion clinical training program.

2599-bb-13. Reporting.

§ 2599-bb-10. Policy and purpose. 1. New York has long held that comprehensive reproductive health care is a fundamental component of every individual's health, privacy and equality, and that access to reproductive health care services is integral to their ability to choose to carry a pregnancy to term, to give birth to a child, or to have an abortion.

2. Abortion care is provided in hospitals, clinics, and private medical practices across the state, with a majority of this care delivered by community-based providers. However, growing maternal health care

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets [-] is old law to be omitted.

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deserts have made it difficult for individuals to access this vital form of care. The need for abortion care continues to increase while the number of providers trained to perform these services is declining. Although there are community-based abortion facilities in every region of the state, only seven out of ten regions have community-based facilities that perform abortion care beyond fifteen weeks of pregnancy. In three regions, only two facilities provide abortion care up to twenty weeks of pregnancy. This has resulted in pregnant people having to travel further, and in some cases out of state, to access care, especially later in pregnancy.

3. While any physician and health care practitioner licensed by the state with abortion in their scope of practice is authorized to provide this care under law, there is no structured training program available to them for this purpose.

4. New York is in a strong position to address the training needs of these individuals by establishing a statewide abortion clinical training program. There are multiple abortion providers who are experienced, utilize innovative abortion care procedures, and interested in training their peers but require funding to do so.

5. It is the purpose of this article to create new training opportunities for New York health care practitioners in the delivery of abortion care through such a program, thereby protecting every individual's right to health, privacy and equality.

§ 2599-bb-11. Definitions. As used in this article, the following terms shall have the following meanings:

1. "Abortion" shall mean the termination of a pregnancy pursuant to section twenty-five hundred ninety-nine-bb of this chapter.

2. "Health care services" shall mean the range of care related to the provision of abortion pursuant to section twenty-five hundred ninety-nine-bb of this chapter.

3. "Health care practitioner" shall mean any health care practitioner authorized to provide health care services pursuant to section twenty-five hundred ninety-nine-bb of this chapter or an intern or resident who is employed by a hospital or otherwise enrolled in an accredited graduate medical education program.

4. "Professional educators" shall mean organizations providing reproductive health care, continuing education programs for qualified providers through professional associations or clinical education programs that meet professionally recognized training standards.

§ 2599-bb-12. Establishment of the New York state abortion clinical training program. 1. (a) There is hereby established within the department the New York state abortion clinical training program for the purpose of training health care practitioners in the performance of abortion and related reproductive health care services. The commissioner in consultation with the state education department, shall adopt a comprehensive curriculum and competency based-standards for the training of health care practitioners in the performance of a full range of abortion and related reproductive health care services. Such curriculum and standards shall be consistent with evidence-based training methods and shall include, but not be limited to:

- (i) counseling and informed consent;
- (ii) miscarriage management;
- (iii) patient-centered care;
- (iv) pre-abortion evaluation;
- (v) contraception and aftercare;
- (vi) telehealth delivery;

1 (vii) procedural abortion;

2 (viii) medication abortion; and

3 (ix) potential complications and required care.

4 (b) The commissioner shall update the adopted curriculum and standards
5 at least every five years.

6 (c) The commissioner shall consult a range of experts, including, but
7 not limited to, individuals and entities providing abortion care,
8 abortion funds, and other organizations whose mission is to expand
9 access to abortion care, to ensure the program structure reflects the
10 needs of abortion providers, abortion funds and consumers in developing
11 the initial curriculum and standards and all subsequent updates.

12 (d) For professional educators currently operating an abortion clin-
13 ical training program within the state and selected by the department to
14 facilitate training through the program, the commissioner shall approve
15 the existing curriculum for use in the New York state abortion clinical
16 training program so long as the curriculum meets adopted statewide stan-
17 dards.

18 3. (a) The commissioner is authorized to enter into agreements with
19 professional educators to facilitate clinical training related to
20 abortion care and other related reproductive health services at a mini-
21 mum of four sites across the state. In entering such agreements, the
22 commissioner shall consider organizations that:

23 (i) comply with applicable state laws and regulations;

24 (ii) are capable of providing culturally congruent care and implicit
25 bias training;

26 (iii) have demonstrated experience in coordinating abortion care
27 training programs; and

28 (iv) have sufficient patient volume to accommodate training need.

29 (b) Professional educators shall not be required to provide training
30 in all areas of the approved curriculum, provided, however, special
31 consideration shall be given to professional educators who have the
32 capability to provide the full range of abortion care and related repro-
33 ductive health care services.

34 (c) The commissioner may engage the services of a consultant on a
35 contract basis to support the administration and operation of the
36 program. Such consultant shall be a professional educator that has the
37 demonstrated ability to provide programmatic oversight on a statewide
38 level including, but not limited to candidate selection and screening,
39 and adherence to the approved curriculum and clinical standards.

40 (d) Each professional educator receiving funding pursuant to this
41 paragraph shall submit a written certification in such form and at such
42 time as the commissioner shall prescribe, attesting how any award made
43 was used to support training health care practitioners in the perform-
44 ance of abortion and related reproductive health care services includ-
45 ing, but not limited to the number of health care practitioners selected
46 for training; the number of health care practitioners completing the
47 training; and the areas of the state served by the health care practi-
48 tioners selected.

49 (e) Notwithstanding any inconsistent provision of law to the contrary,
50 the commissioner shall be authorized to recoup any award made and deter-
51 mined to have been used in a manner inconsistent with the purposes of
52 the abortion clinical training program. The commissioner is authorized
53 to employ any legal mechanism to recoup such funds, including an offset
54 of other funds that are owed to such professional educator.

1 4. The commissioner shall prioritize eligible health care practition-
2 ers who will provide abortion and related reproductive health care
3 services to underserved communities in the state to receive training.

4 5. The commissioner shall award and distribute grants to address prac-
5 tical support needs of eligible health care providers. Funds may be
6 awarded to support an eligible health care practitioner in obtaining
7 clinical education on abortion care and other reproductive health
8 services, including, but not limited to, financial support for travel
9 and lodging associated with attending the program.

10 6. The commissioner shall promulgate rules and regulations as are
11 necessary to carry out the provisions of this section.

12 7. Nothing in this article shall be construed to limit or restrict
13 abortion training that occurs within New York state separate and apart
14 from the New York state abortion clinical training program.

15 § 2599-bb-13. Reporting. The commissioner shall submit a report no
16 later than twelve months after the effective date of this section and
17 annually thereafter, to the governor, the temporary president of the
18 senate and the speaker of the assembly, which shall include, but not be
19 limited to, the total amount of grants issued, the number of eligible
20 participants, the number of eligible providers, and the region of the
21 state where the eligible providers are located. Notwithstanding any
22 other provision of law, the commissioner shall not report any identify-
23 ing information of eligible participants in the program.

24 § 2. This act shall take effect on the first of April next succeeding
25 the date upon which it shall have become a law. Effective immediately,
26 the addition, amendment and/or repeal of any rule or regulation neces-
27 sary for the implementation of this act on its effective date are
28 authorized to be made and completed on or before such effective date.